

INTEGRATED MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS

# IMC PLAN & PITCH

*An Integrated Marketing Communications Plan for Stanley 1913*

**Sumeet Telgote**

MKTG 4480-01 — Dr. Stanley Nwobodo  
Thompson Rivers University  
November 26, 2024

## Contents

|   |                           |    |
|---|---------------------------|----|
| 1 | Situation Analysis.....   | 3  |
| 2 | Strategic Objectives..... | 5  |
| 3 | Strategies & Tactics..... | 6  |
| 4 | Measurement.....          | 9  |
| 5 | Recommendations.....      | 10 |
| 6 | References.....           | 11 |

# 1 Situation Analysis

---

Group B: Timur Zonduev (T00726802), Rachel Nguyen (T00716645), Hyeeun Park (T00760771), Sumeet Telgote (T00711269). Submitted November 26, 2024.

## 1. Background Analysis of Stanley 1913

**Brand Overview:** Stanley 1913, founded by William Stanley Jr., revolutionized drinkware with the invention of the all-steel vacuum bottle in 1913. The brand is known for its durable, high-quality outdoor gear, particularly insulated food and beverage containers. Over the years, Stanley has expanded its product range to include bottles, tumblers, growlers, and more, catering to rugged, active lifestyles.

**Market/Industry:** Stanley operates in the drinkware industry, which includes a variety of products such as bottles, mugs, and tumblers. The industry is characterized by a growing demand for eco-friendly and sustainable products. Key competitors include Yeti, Hydro Flask, and Thermos.

## 2. Current Media Trends in the Industry

**Competitors:** Yeti and Hydro Flask are known for their high-quality, durable drinkware and have a strong market presence, focusing heavily on outdoor and adventure themes. Thermos, another long-standing competitor, offers a wide range of insulated products and has a strong reputation for reliability.

**Customers:** an increasing preference for eco-friendly and sustainable products; a growing trend of personalization and custom-designed drinkware; and high demand for products that cater to on-the-go lifestyles.

**Suppliers and Intermediaries:** suppliers are focusing on sustainable materials like stainless steel and BPA-free plastics. Retail intermediaries include both physical stores and online platforms, with a significant shift towards e-commerce.

## 3. Current Business Goals, Marketing Strategies, and Communication Tactics

**Business Goals:** increase market share in the drinkware industry; expand the customer base to include a broader demographic, particularly women.

**Marketing Strategies:** Rebranding — Stanley shifted from a male-dominated outdoor brand to a versatile lifestyle brand appealing to women. Influencer Marketing — collaborations with influencers and social media campaigns have been pivotal in reaching new audiences. Limited Edition Releases — creating a sense of exclusivity with limited edition products.

**Communication Strategies and Tactics:** Social Media Engagement — active presence on platforms like Instagram and TikTok, leveraging user-generated content and viral marketing. Storytelling — emphasizing the durability and emotional connection of their products through customer stories and brand narratives. Collaborations — partnering with other brands and influencers to reach new audiences.

## 4. Target Audience Analysis

**Audience Personas:** Outdoor Enthusiasts — traditionally Stanley's core audience, including campers, hikers, and blue-collar workers. Millennial and Gen Z Women — recently targeted through influencer marketing and social media campaigns. Families and Everyday Users — expanding to include products for daily use, appealing to a broader demographic.

Customer Journeys: Awareness — through social media, influencer endorsements, and viral content. Consideration — engaging content and storytelling that highlights product benefits and emotional connections. Purchase — easy access through e-commerce platforms and physical stores. Post-Purchase — encouraging user-generated content and community engagement to foster brand loyalty.

## 5. Key Areas for Improvement

Enhanced Personalization — offering more customizable options to cater to individual preferences. Sustainability Initiatives — highlighting eco-friendly practices and products to appeal to environmentally conscious consumers. Expanded Influencer Partnerships — collaborating with a diverse range of influencers to reach different segments of the market. Interactive Content — creating more interactive and engaging content, such as live Q&A sessions, tutorials, and behind-the-scenes looks.

By leveraging these insights and focusing on these key areas, Stanley 1913 can further enhance its integrated marketing communications and continue to grow its market presence.

## 2 Strategic Objectives

---

### 1. Increase Brand Awareness Through Sustainability Messaging

**Objective:** increase brand awareness by 20% within the target audience over six months by integrating sustainability initiatives into 50% of all communication channels and campaigns.

**Rationale:** based on market analysis, sustainability is a top priority for both Stanley and its consumers. Highlighting sustainability through clear messaging aligns with the business goal of promoting social responsibility and brand image, and attracts environmentally conscious customers.

**Duration:** 6 months (January–June 2025, ~26 weeks). Weeks 1–4: audit current channels, develop sustainability-focused messaging, align content calendars. Weeks 5–12: launch sustainability-themed campaigns, monitor and optimize, track awareness via impressions/clicks/shares. Weeks 13–21: scale up successful strategies, introduce behind-the-scenes storytelling. Weeks 22–26: final analysis comparing baseline to post-campaign awareness.

### 2. Enhance Customer Engagement Through Personalized and Interactive Content

**Objective:** achieve a 25% increase in customer engagement across digital platforms within three months by implementing interactive and personalized content such as quizzes, polls, and tailored product recommendations.

**Rationale:** market analysis indicates customers value brands catering to their specific needs and preferences. Personalization and interactivity create a more engaging experience, building stronger emotional connections and increasing the likelihood of repeat interactions.

**Duration:** 3 months (February–April 2025, ~13 weeks). Weeks 1–4: analyze customer data, develop quizzes/polls and a recommendation engine, plan launch content. Weeks 5–8: launch personalized campaigns, implement dynamic email content, monitor engagement metrics. Weeks 9–13: iterate based on responses, add new interactive elements, compare baseline vs. achieved engagement against the 25% target.

### 3. Lead Generation Campaigns via Expanded Influencer Partnerships and UGC Competitions

**Objective:** generate 1,000 qualified leads from influencer-driven campaigns within four months by collaborating with 15–20 influencers whose audiences align with the brand's target demographics, running competitions, giveaways, and UGC campaigns.

**Rationale:** influencer partnerships have proven effective in amplifying reach and driving conversions. Expanding this strategy aligns with the business goal of driving sales while maintaining an honest connection with the audience.

**Duration:** 4 months (March–June 2025, ~17 weeks). Weeks 1–4: identify and shortlist 15–20 influencers, develop campaign briefs. Weeks 5–8: launch initial campaigns and giveaways, set up lead-tracking (unique links/promo codes). Weeks 9–13: expand campaigns, begin UGC campaigns, track leads toward the 1,000-lead goal. Weeks 14–17: analyze progress, host a final giveaway/competition push, summarize ROI.

### 3 Strategies & Tactics

#### Objective 1: Increase Brand Awareness Through Sustainability Messaging

Strategy: implement a comprehensive sustainability campaign that highlights Stanley's commitment to environmental responsibility across all communication channels.

Tactics and Channels: Content Marketing — blog posts, videos, and infographics on sustainability initiatives (recycled materials, reduced plastic packaging). Social Media Campaigns — behind-the-scenes looks at sustainable practices on Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter. Email Newsletters — regular updates on eco-friendly products and sustainability milestones. Partnerships — collaborating with environmental organizations on co-hosted events or campaigns.

Justification: sustainability messaging aligns with Stanley's brand values and appeals to environmentally conscious consumers, potentially increasing market share; consumers increasingly prioritize sustainability, so showcasing these efforts can enhance brand loyalty and trust.

#### Media Plan

| Platform          | Timing           | Purpose                                    |
|-------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Blog              | Bi-weekly posts  | Educate audience on sustainability efforts |
| Social Media      | Daily updates    | Engage and inform followers                |
| Email Newsletters | Monthly          | Keep subscribers informed and engaged      |
| Partnerships      | Quarterly events | Broaden reach and credibility              |

#### Action Plan

| Task                                | Timeframe | Responsibility | Budget Estimate |
|-------------------------------------|-----------|----------------|-----------------|
| Develop content calendar            | 2 weeks   | Content Team   | \$2,000         |
| Create multimedia content           | Ongoing   | Marketing Team | \$5,000         |
| Identify and approach partners      | 1 month   | PR Team        | \$3,000         |
| Monitor and analyze campaign impact | Ongoing   | Analytics Team | \$2,000         |

#### Objective 2: Enhance Customer Engagement Through Personalized and Interactive Content

Strategy: launch personalized and interactive digital experiences to deepen customer engagement and foster a sense of community.

Tactics and Channels: Interactive Quizzes — product recommendations based on user preferences. User-Generated Content (UGC) — encouraging customers to share product experiences on social media, with selected posts featured on official channels. Personalized Email Campaigns — tailored recommendations

and content based on customer behavior and purchase history. Virtual Events — webinars or live streams demonstrating product uses, care tips, and sustainability discussions.

Justification: personalized and interactive content can increase customer retention and lifetime value by fostering deeper connections, and makes customers feel valued and understood.

### Media Plan

| Platform       | Timing              | Purpose                             |
|----------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Website        | Monthly quizzes     | Drive traffic and engagement        |
| Social Media   | Weekly UGC features | Drive traffic and engagement        |
| Email          | Bi-weekly campaigns | Maintain personalized communication |
| Virtual Events | Quarterly           | Educate and engage customers        |

### Action Plan

| Task                                    | Timeframe | Responsibility    | Budget Estimate |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------|-----------------|
| Develop interactive content             | 1 month   | Digital Team      | \$4,000         |
| Set up UGC campaigns                    | 2 weeks   | Social Media Team | \$2,000         |
| Segment email lists for personalization | 3 weeks   | CRM Team          | \$3,000         |
| Plan and execute virtual events         | 2 months  | Events Team       | \$5,000         |

### Objective 3: Lead Generation Campaigns via Expanded Influencer Partnerships and UGC Competitions

Strategy: collaborate with influencers to create engaging campaigns that include giveaways and user-driven design competitions, showcasing Stanley products while fostering a sense of community and ownership among customers.

Influencer Partnerships: sign contracts with 15–20 influencers from lifestyle, outdoor, and sustainability niches to create a series of posts and videos featuring Stanley products, focused on Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube, with exclusive discount codes or tracking links for each influencer.

Giveaways: a “Picture with Stanley” campaign where participants share creative photos using Stanley products, tagging the brand with a campaign hashtag (#MyStanleyWaterbottle); winners receive gift cards, exclusive products, or a feature on Stanley's official social media.

User-Driven Design Competition: fans submit custom designs for Stanley products (e.g., tumbler or water bottle artwork); the winning design is featured in a limited-edition product line, with credit to the designer.

**Lead Magnets and Landing Pages:** dedicated landing pages for giveaways and design competitions to collect participant data (e.g., email addresses) for future campaigns.

**Evidence-Based Justification:** influencers drive 11x higher ROI than traditional marketing (HubSpot); competitions build strong brand loyalty, emotional connection, and repeat purchases.

**Justification of Media Choices:** Instagram/TikTok — highly visual, high engagement, especially among younger audiences. YouTube — excellent for in-depth product storytelling and long-form content on durability and usability. Email Campaigns — keeps participants engaged with updates and offers. Website Landing Pages — centralizes campaign participation and data collection.

## Media Plan

| Platform              | Timing                    | Purpose                                            |
|-----------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Instagram/TikTok      | Weekly influencer posts   | Boost visibility, engagement, and trend potential. |
| YouTube               | Monthly influencer videos | Showcase products in authentic, real-world use.    |
| Email Campaigns       | Bi-weekly                 | Drive participation in giveaways and competitions. |
| Website Landing Pages | Ongoing                   | Capture leads and drive competition participation. |

## Action Plan

| Task                                   | Timeframe                        | Responsibility           | Budget Estimate                |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Identify and contract influencers      | 1 month                          | Digital Team             | \$30,000                       |
| Launch "Picture with Stanley" giveaway | 6 weeks (prep) + 2 months (live) | Social Media Team        | \$10,000                       |
| Create competition landing pages       | 3 weeks                          | Web Development Team     | \$5,000                        |
| Host user design competition           | 3 months                         | Marketing & Design Teams | \$15,000 (production + prizes) |

**Expected Outcomes:** increased engagement from influencer content and user-generated campaigns; boosted sales from tracked influencer-driven conversions and competition-driven leads; stronger customer loyalty from giving customers a stake in Stanley's product line.



## 4 Measurement

---

### Objective 1: Increase Brand Awareness Through Sustainability Messaging

**NPS (Net Promoter Score):** the extent to which people who engaged with the campaign would recommend the brand. A high NPS indicates increased customer satisfaction and brand loyalty, and quantitatively shows whether sustainability messaging is driving trust and loyalty. Measured via a 0–10 recommendation survey (Promoters 9–10, Passives 7–8, Detractors 0–6), distributed through email surveys to newsletter subscribers, website pop-up surveys after engaging with sustainability content, and post-event feedback for sustainability initiatives.

**Volume Data:** the total number of interactions, sales, or activities within a period — website visitors, social media reach, content views, and email opens/clicks — used to gauge consumer interest and engagement, and whether the sustainability message changed loyalty and participation. Collected via website traffic, social media engagement (likes/shares/comments), email open rates, and campaign/event participation (registration forms and attendance records).

### Objective 2: Enhance Customer Engagement Through Personalized and Interactive Content

**CES (Customer Effort Score):** measures how easy it is for customers to engage with the brand or complete an action. If the quizzes, UGC campaigns, and personalized experiences are easy to access and use, a higher CES signals a smoother, more enjoyable experience. Collected via post-interaction surveys (“Very Easy” to “Very Difficult”) embedded on the website or emailed after interactions.

**Engagement Rate (Quizzes/UGC):** tracks likes, shares, comments, and participation in quizzes or UGC campaigns to assess “ease of customer experience” and “customer participation.” Collected via social media and website analytics tools, email marketing platform metrics (open/click-through rates), and virtual-event platform engagement reports (attendance, chat activity, question submissions).

### Objective 3: Lead Generation via Expanded Influencer Partnerships and UGC Competitions

**Sales Conversion Rate:** the percentage of visitors or participants who complete a purchase after engaging with a campaign ( $\text{purchases} \div \text{participants/visitors} \times 100\%$ ). A crucial metric for assessing how effectively marketing efforts drive revenue and which channels generate the highest ROI.

**Influencer Partnerships:** tracked via unique discount codes/links per influencer, plus social media engagement (likes, shares, comments).

**Giveaway:** tracked via the campaign hashtag (#MyStanleyWaterbottle) across social platforms — participant counts, shared posts, and tagged photos.

**User-Driven Design Competitions:** tracked via submission platforms (web forms) and related social media activity.

**Lead Magnets and Landing Pages:** tracked via sign-up forms on dedicated landing pages, capturing email addresses and preferences for future campaigns.

## 5 Recommendations

---

### Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Sustainability Practices

To establish Stanley as a leader in sustainable practices, we recommend hiring a CSR expert. Why it matters: customers are increasingly aligning with brands that reflect their values, particularly in sustainability. Action plan: assess Stanley's current sustainability efforts; identify areas for improvement such as reducing environmental impact in manufacturing and packaging; develop measurable, transparent goals (e.g., lowering carbon emissions, using recycled materials). Outcome: positions Stanley as an authentic, eco-conscious brand, resonating with environmentally-aware consumers and enhancing brand reputation.

### Use of Outsourcing Companies

Effective social media management requires specialized skills and expertise, so we recommend outsourcing to a professional marketing agency. Why: in-house teams may lack the time or expertise for advanced campaigns, while agencies bring fresh perspectives, innovative tools, and data-driven strategies. Action plan: partner with a reputable agency aligned with Stanley's brand values, focused on engaging, visually compelling content tailored to Stanley's audience. Outcome: a cohesive, professional approach to marketing that increases engagement, brand reach, and ROI.

### Social Media Marketing Plan

A strategic, well-organized social media marketing (SMM) campaign is essential for building awareness and maintaining relevance. Why: planning a campaign 3 months in advance allows for consistency, creativity, and alignment with key events or trends. Action plan: define campaign goals and target audience personas; use a mix of content formats (short videos, tutorials, UGC, contests); incorporate sustainable practices into messaging (e.g., behind-the-scenes of eco-friendly production). Outcome: higher engagement, consistent messaging, and increased customer loyalty.

### Listen to Audience

Social media is a two-way communication channel. Why: customers want to feel heard and valued — engaging sincerely builds trust and loyalty. Action plan: assign a dedicated team to monitor comments, direct messages, and mentions across platforms; be transparent in responses, addressing concerns honestly; use audience feedback to refine products and marketing strategies. Example tactic: host regular Q&A sessions or polls to learn what resonates with customers. Outcome: fosters community, boosts brand authenticity, and keeps Stanley attuned to evolving customer preferences.

## 6 References

---

George E. Belch, Michael A. Belch, Michael A. Guolla. Advertising & Promotion: An Integrated Marketing Communications Perspective, 5th Canadian ed. McGraw-Hill Ryerson, 2014.

Luthans, F., & Doh, J. ISE International Management: Culture, Strategy, and Behavior, 11th Edition. eBook in Connect: 9781260563917.

About Stanley | Since 1913 | Built For Life.

Stanley 1913: Brand Positioning Case Study — Empathy Marketing.

Drinkware Market Share, Size | Forecasts Report, 2023–2032.

Drinkware Industry Statistics: Market Data Report 2024.

Drinkware Market Size Report, 2030 — Grand View Research.

The Rise of the Stanley Tumbler: How a 110-Year-Old Brand Achieved Viral Success.

Consumer Marketing Strategies Behind the Stanley Cup Craze — SHIFT.

Raise the Stanley: Our Observations of Stanley's Marketing Transformation.

VENTURZ — 10 Metrics & KPIs to Measure Brand Awareness.

The Ultimate List of Customer Engagement Metrics & KPIs.

Benefits of Influencer Marketing, by HubSpot.